

These are simple cases of disagreement. Many people have the intuition that, in cases like these, disagreement should lead us to revise our beliefs.

Whenever someone has as many of the qualities which are relevant to correctly answering some question as you do, we will say that that person is your **epistemic peer**.

Intuitively, the idea is that your epistemic peer is just as likely to give the correct answer to some question as you are. So, if an epistemic peer disagrees with you, you should reduce your confidence in your own belief.

Of course, we are making some background assumptions about these cases. For example, in the case of the horse race we are assuming that the other person has as good of eyesight as you do. And in the splitting the bill case we are assuming that your friends are not terrible at math.

Probability-splitting

If you assign P credence N , and come across an epistemic peer who assigns P credence M , then you should change your credence in P to the average of N and M .

This rule also seems to say the right thing about cases in which you meet a large number of epistemic peers who disagree with you.

The poll

I put an argument on the screen, and conduct a poll, asking you to say whether the argument is valid or invalid. You confidently answer “Valid.” When the poll results show up, you find to your surprise that you are the only student who answered this way.

We can think of this as a case in which you have many simultaneous disagreements.

Supposing for simplicity that everyone initially has credence 1 in her answer and that everyone in the class is your epistemic peer, the Probability Splitting Rule would suggest that you should lower your credence in your initial answer to 0.5, then to 0.25, then to 0.125, then to a small number.

Of course, we are making some background assumptions about these cases. For example, in the case of the horse race we are assuming that the other person has as good of eyesight as you do. And in the splitting the bill case we are assuming that your friends are not terrible at math.

There are simple cases of disagreement. Many people have the intuition that, in

cases like these, disagreement should lead us to revise our beliefs.

peer.

answering some question as you do, we will say that that person is your epistemic

Whenever someone has as many of the qualities which are relevant to

Intuitively, the idea is that your epistemic peer is just as likely to give the correct

answer to some question you are. So, if an epistemic peer disagrees with you,

you should reduce your confidence in your own belief.

Of course, we are making some background assumptions about these cases. For

example, in the case of the horse race we are assuming that the other person has

your friends are not terrible at math.

good eyesight as you do. And in the splitting the bill case we are assuming that



across an epistemic peer who assigns P

credence in P to the average of N and M .

credence M , then you should change your

If you assign P credence N , and come

Probability-splitting

This rule also seems to say the right thing about cases in which you meet a large

number of peer-reviewed papers who disagree with you.

Probability Splitting Rule says just the right thing

about.

Here is a different case which, many think, the

you should verify your credentials in your initial answer to 0.5, then to 0.25, then to 0.125, then

Supposing for simplicity that everyone initially has credence 1 in the answer and that

We can think of this as a case in which you have many simultaneous disagreements

to...as main number.

every one in the class is your epistemic peer, the Probability Splitting Rule would suggest that

What should you say in this case? Why?

Why? We can think of this as a case in which you have many simultaneous disagreements.

Splitting Rule would suggest that you should have your credentials in your initial answer to

Supposing for simplicity that everyone initially has credence 1 in answer, the Probability

0.5, then to 0.25, then to 0.125, then to . . . a small number.

The poll

I put an argument on the screen, and conduct a poll, asking you to say whether the argument is valid or invalid. You confidently answer “Valid.” When the poll results show up, you find to your surprise that you are the only student who answered this way.